Murat Abus

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Employment & Affiliations

Postdoctoral Fellow in Political Science — *Jonesboro, AR*
Arkansas State University — *2026-present*

Affiliate Researcher at the Institute for Rural Initiatives — *Jonesboro, AR*
Arkansas State University — *2026-present*

Affiliate Researcher at the Institute for Democracy, Journalism and Citizenship — *Washington, D.C.*
Syracuse University — *2026-present*

Education

Ph.D. in Political Science — *Syracuse, NY*
Syracuse University — *2026*

M.A. in Political Science — *Jonesboro, AR*
Arkansas State University — *2021*

B.A. in Political Science — *Istanbul, Turkey*
Bogazici University — *1998*

Research

Publications

** indicates equal authorship; author order is alphabetical*

Journal Articles

5. **Murat Abus** and Sabri Ciftci. 2026. "Administrative Unit Proliferation in Parliamentary Systems: Evidence from Turkish Elections, 1960-2018." *Electoral Studies* 101: 103087.

4. **Murat Abus** and Kexin Bai and Johanna Dunaway. 2025. "Local News, Partisanship, and Perceptions About Election Administration." *Electoral Studies* 97: 102970.

3. **Murat Abus**. 2025. "The Gendered Politics of Candidate Selection: An Analysis of Left-Right Preferences in Parliamentary Democracies." *Political Research Quarterly* 78 (3): 1060-1073.

2. **Murat Abus**. 2024. "A Theory of Gender's Effect on Vote Shift with a Test Based on Turkish Elections." *Mediterranean Politics* 29 (5): 729-754.

1. **Murat Abus**. 2003. "Democratization in the Balkans, 1990-2002." *Alternatives: Turkish Journal of International Relations* 2 (3&4): 86-105.

Works in Progress

7. **Murat Abus**. "Electoral Consequences of Administrative Reforms."

6. **Murat Abus** and Cameron Wimpy. "Nationalization of Local Elections." (under review).

5. Cameron Wimpy and **Murat Abus**. "Turnout in Local Elections."

4. **Murat Abus** and Johanna Dunaway. "Local News and Political Competition."

3. Sabri Ciftci and **Murat Abus**. "Municipalities and Territorial Reforms in the Context of Authoritarianism."

2. **Murat Abus** and Cameron Wimpy. "Local Media Access and Voter Confidence."

1. **Murat Abus** and Kexin Bai. "A New Look at Voter Confidence."

Research Interests

Political Behavior; Election Science; Political Communication; Public Opinion; Comparative Public Administration; Local Politics; Local News; Democracy and Autocracy

Grants

Professionalization and Administrative Capacity in Rural Election Offices ($90,000)
The Center for Tech and Civic Life *2026-2027*
Role: Senior Personnel · PI: Cameron Wimpy

Conference Presentations

"Local Media Access and Voter Confidence" *St. Pete, FL*
Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Cameron Wimpy) *January 2027*

"Municipalities and Territorial Reforms in the Context of Authoritarianism" *St. Pete, FL*
Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Sabri Ciftci) *January 2027*

"Left in the Dark: Local Newspaper Closure and Rural Political Disengagement" *Phoenix, AZ*
Election Sciences, Reform, and Administration Conference (with Cameron Wimpy) *June 2026*

"The Nonstationary Geography of Nationalization in American Elections, 2000-2024" *Chicago, IL*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Cameron Wimpy) *April 2026*

"Local News and Political Competition" *Washington, D.C.*
National Capital Area Political Science Association American Politics Workshop (with Johanna Dunaway) *January 2026*

"Social Context, Unemployment, and Local News: A New Look at Voter Confidence" *Tallahassee, FL*
Election Sciences, Reform, and Administration Conference (with Johanna Dunaway) *June 2025*

"Uncontested Elections and Declining Local News" *Stony Brook, NY*
Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Conference (with Johanna Dunaway) *May 2025*

"Local News Effects on Down-Ballot Electoral Competition" *Houston, TX*
Mini Conference on Information and Messages in Sociopolitical Life (with Johanna Dunaway) *May 2025*

"Local News and Minority and Women Candidate Emergence" *Washington, D.C.*
Gender, Race, and Ethnicity Politics Workshop (with Johanna Dunaway and Paru Shah) *May 2025*

"Subnational Unit Proliferation and Electoral Dynamics: The Case of Turkey" *Chicago, IL*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Sabri Ciftci) *April 2025*

"Local News Declines, Incumbency Effects and the Electoral Fortunes of Women and Candidates of Color" *Chicago, IL*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Johanna Dunaway and Paru Shah) *April 2025*

"Local News and the Down-Ballot Incumbency Advantage" *Chicago, IL*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Johanna Dunaway) *April 2025*

"Social Context, Unemployment, and Local News: A New Look at Voter Confidence" *Chicago, IL*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Johanna Dunaway) *April 2025*

"Political Economy of Demographic Aging: New Pressures on Voter Turnout" *Chicago, IL*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Margarita Estévez-Abe) *April 2025*

"Electoral Consequences of Administrative Unit Proliferation: Evidence from Turkey" *Chicago, IL*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting *April 2025*

"Spatial Analysis of News Deserts: The Distribution of U.S. Local Newspapers" *Durham, NC*
Local Journalism Researchers Workshop (with Johanna Dunaway) *March 2025*

"Government Type, Electoral Dynamics, and Subnational Unit Proliferation in Turkey" *Virtual presentation*
PSA Turkish Politics Online Workshop (with Sabri Ciftci) *February 2025*

"Local Media and Voter Confidence" *San Juan, PR*
Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Johanna Dunaway) *January 2025*

"Local News and the Down-Ballot Incumbency Advantage" *Philadelphia, PA*
American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Johanna Dunaway) *September 2024*

"Media Access and Perceptions of Election Administration" *Chicago, IL*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Kexin Bai and Johanna Dunaway) *April 2024*

"Inequality, Local Media, and Voter Confidence" *Chicago, IL*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Kexin Bai and Johanna Dunaway) *April 2024*

"Variety of Women Candidates in Parliamentary Democracies" *Chicago, IL*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Sarah A. Fulton) *April 2024*

"Subnational Unit Proliferation: Evidence from Turkey" *Chicago, IL*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting *April 2024*

"Local Media Access and Perceptions of Election Integrity" *Durham, NC*
Local News Researchers Workshop (with Kexin Bai and Johanna Dunaway) *March 2024*

"Media, Partisanship, and Election Integrity" *Tallahassee, FL*
Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Conference (with Kexin Bai and Johanna Dunaway) *March 2024*

"Media Access and Perceptions of Election Administration" *New Orleans, LA*
Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Kexin Bai and Johanna Dunaway) *January 2024*

"Variety of Women Candidates in Parliamentary Democracies" *New Orleas, LA*

Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Sarah A. Fulton) *January 2024*

"Partisanship and Election Administration" *New Orleans, LA*
Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting *January 2024*

"Inequality and Voter Confidence in American Elections" *New Orleans, LA*
Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting *January 2024*

"Reforming and Backsliding: A Comparative Analysis of Administrative Reforms in Hungary and Turkey" *Chicago, IL*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting *April 2023*

"Reforming and Backsliding: A Comparative Analysis of Administrative Reforms in Hungary and Turkey (poster presentation)" *Lubbock, TX*
Texas Comparative Politics Circle Annual Conference *January 2023*

"Electoral Consequences of Administrative Reforms in Turkey (1985-2018)" *St. Pete, FL*
Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting *January 2023*

"Electoral Consequences of Administrative Reforms (poster presentation)" *Houston, TX*
Southern Workshop in Empirical Political Science *May 2022*

"Democracy at the Intersection of Religious Cleavage and Populism" *Virtual presentation*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting *April 2022*

"Ideology and Gender Role Incongruity: Resilience and Rise of Parties under Authoritarianism (poster presentation)" *Austin, TX*
Texas Comparative Politics Circle Annual Conference *February 2022*

"Ideology and Gender Role Incongruity: The Rise of IYI Party in Perspective" *San Antonio, TX*
Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting *January 2022*

"Clientelism and Structured Voting: Evidence from Turkey" *virtual presentation*
Southwestern Social Science Association Annual Meeting *April 2021*

"Are We There Yet? Political Participation in Transitional Democracies" *Virtual presentation*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Cameron Wimpy) *April 2021*

"Do Elections Create or Further Path Dependencies?" *Virtual presentation*
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting *April 2021*

"Election Administration and UOCAVA Voting" *Virtual presentation*
Arkansas Political Science Association Annual Meeting *February 2021*

"Clientelism and Structured Voting: Evidence from Turkey" *Virtual presentation*
Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting *January 2021*

"Reflections in the Mirror: Authoritarian Values and Political Identities in Turkey" *Arkadelphia, AR*
Arkansas Political Science Association *March 2020*

"A Model of Voter Turnout in Bulgaria and Romania" *Istanbul, Turkey*
Graduate Conference of Turkish Political Science Association *October 2004*

"Democratization in the Balkans, 1990-2002" *Istanbul, Turkey*
Graduate Conference of Turkish Political Science Association *October 2003*

Teaching

Teaching Interests

Introduction to Data Analysis; Applied Data Analysis; Advanced Data Analysis; Data Visualization; Comparative Politics; Political Behavior; Election Science; Local Elections and Local Politics; Authoritarianism & Populism; Media and Politics; Political Psychology; Comparing Democracies / Comparative Political Behavior; Public Opinion and Political Parties; Russian State & Politics; Politics of Developing Countries

Courses & Workshops Taught

PLSC 40303, Terrorism and Political Violence *Spring 2027*
Arkansas State University

PLSC 20003, Introduction to US Government *Spring 2027*
Arkansas State University

PLSC 34053, Introduction to Political Analysis *Fall 2026*
Arkansas State University

PLSC 33203, Introduction to Comparative Politics *Fall 2026*
Arkansas State University

PLSC 66003, Advanced Political Analysis *Fall 2026*
Arkansas State University

Fellowships, Honors & Awards

Graduate research assistantship
Syracuse University *2024–2026*

Outstanding Graduate Student
Political Science Department, Arkansas State University *2021*

Graduate research/teaching assistantship
Arkansas State University *2019–2021*

Professional Memberships & Service

Peer Reviewer
Political Research Quarterly (6), *Electoral Studies (2)*, *Political Communication (1)*, *Politics and Religion (1)*, *Mediterranean Politics (1)*, *Electronic News (1)*

Panel Discussant
2022 MPSA, 2027 SPSA

Panel Chair
2022 MPSA, 2024 MPSA, 2025 SPSA, 2026 MPSA

Skills & Software

Languages
English (Fluent), Turkish (Native), Russian (Upper Intermediate B2)

Methods
Spatial Econometrics, Matching Analysis, Survival Analysis, Panel Data

Software
R, Stata, LaTeX, GeoDa, Qualtrics

Certifications

Russian Language Certification
Privet Language School, Kaliningrad, Russia *2014*

Research Methodology & Software Workshops

From Text to Insights: Building and Analyzing Custom Political Event Data
ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods *2025*

Stata Courses for Panel Data, Survival Analysis, and Programming
StataCorp *2025*

Professional References

Dr. Sabri Ciftci
Professor of Political Science
Michael W. Suleiman Chair in Arab and Arab-American Studies
Kansas State University
Manhattan, KS 66506
ciftci@ksu.edu

Dr. Johanna Dunaway
Professor of Political Science
Research Director at Institute for Democracy, Journalism, and Citizenship
Syracuse University
Washington, D.C. 20036
jldunawa@syr.edu

Dr. William P. McLean
Provost and Executive Vice Chancellor
Academic Affairs and Research
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Dr. Michelle Taylor-Robinson
Professor, Mays Family Foundation Bulding Democracy Chair
Associate Dean for Research & Graduate Education
Texas A&M University
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m-taylor11@tamu.edu

Dr. Emily Thorson
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Syracuse University
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Dr. Cameron Wimpy
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